



Appeal for aid

The American Red Cross established 50 camps to aid South Vietnamese civilians impacted by the conflict: facilities that provided food, shelter, clothing, and medical care, and helped villagers rebuild their war-ravaged homes and farms.

Flawed system

One of the offspring of CORDS was the Hamlet Evaluation System (HES)—through which the US collected and analyzed data on more than 9,000 hamlets and villages across South Vietnam. Compiled by US advisers stationed in the countryside, the data rated the security situation in every hamlet, leading to a monthly report that supposedly reflected the increasing (or decreasing) loyalty of rural residents to the South Vietnamese regime and American war effort. Given the pressure on advisers to increase security in their zone, it